

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Bible Study Methods

The S.O.A.P. Method

A free resource from JesusOnline.

Read or share online: equip.jesonline.com/channels/church/bible-study-methods/soap-method

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

The S.O.A.P. Method

The **S.O.A.P.** Method is a simple, popular way to study the Bible personally or in a journal — especially great for daily devotionals or quiet times. It helps you move from just reading Scripture to really letting it sink in, change your heart, and connect you with God. The acronym stands for four easy steps.

S — Scripture

Pick a short Bible passage (one verse, a few verses, or a small section). Read it carefully — maybe out loud — then write it out word for word in your notebook or journal. Writing it helps you slow down, notice every word, and let it stick in your mind. Many people say this step alone reveals fresh insights.

O — Observation

Look closely at what the text actually says. Jot down honest observations — no deep interpretation yet, just facts and what catches your eye.

- What jumps out at me?
- What words, ideas, or phrases repeat or stand out?
- Who is speaking? Who is it to? What's happening?
- What does this show about God, people, or life?

A — Application

Bring it home: how does this truth apply to your life right now? Ask God:

- What should I believe, stop doing, start doing, or change in my attitude or behavior?
- How can this help me love God more or love others better?

Make it personal and practical (for example, “Because God forgives me fully, I need to forgive the person who hurt me this week”). Be specific so it's actionable.

P — Prayer

Talk to God about what you've learned. Thank Him for the truth, confess if it shows an area of sin or need, ask for help to live it out, and pray for others if the passage leads you there. End your time by responding to God in prayer.

Getting Started

S.O.A.P. keeps Bible study straightforward, heartfelt, and life-changing without needing fancy tools. Grab a notebook, pick a verse (try something from Psalms, Proverbs, or the Gospels to start), pray for the Holy Spirit's help, and give it a try today. You'll be amazed how God's Word speaks directly to you.